Lesson plan · for the teacher

Safer school WhatsApp groups

Cyber safety · Level 1 · Lesson 4

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk (or a large sheet of paper); Large paper for the rules poster, and pens or chalk; Six example posts on slips of paper; Worksheet: Safe group check (one per pair, optional)

Learning goals

- Explain why photos, marks and phone numbers should never be posted in big groups.
- Design five clear rules for a class group and explain each one.
- Describe how to check an urgent request and report a strange message.

Activity: Our class group rules: Rule makers

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask who is in, or knows of, a family, football or faith group chat. Ask: what is the group for, and who decides what gets posted?
2. Teach (8 min): Read out the six example posts. For each, pupils vote: fine for a big group, share privately, or never share. Explain that photos, marks and numbers can be forwarded to anyone.
3. Rule makers (14 min): Groups of four write five rules for a class group: what it's for, who posts, what is never shared, how we treat each other, and what to do with a strange or urgent message.
4. Share (7 min): Each group reads its best rule. Build one class poster from the most popular rules, making sure it includes "check urgent requests with an adult" and "report and block strangers".
5. Wrap-up (6 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one thing they will never post in a group and what they would do with a strange message. Everyone signs the poster.

Draw a large phone on the board with an empty group chat. Write six example posts on slips of paper: a class photo, a mark list, a homework reminder, a phone number, an "urgent money" message and a match result.

Discussion

- What happens in a group with no rules?
- Could a new pupil understand each rule in one reading?
- Which rule protects us most?

Exit ticket

- One thing I'll never post + what I do with a strange message.

Try it in class tomorrow
Write class group rules together: Draw a phone on the board with an empty group chat. Ask: what is this group for, who may post, what must never be shared, and what do we do with a strange message? Write five rules together and let everyone sign.

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **You're the admin of a 200-parent notice group. Which settings help?**

- [ ] Turn off all notifications
- [ ] Share the invite link on public pages
- [ ] Only admins can edit group info
- [ ] Admins approve new members
- [ ] Only admins can send messages

2 **A school WhatsApp group is private, so pupils' marks can be posted there.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

3 **Match each setting to the problem it solves.**

Only admins send messages	• • • •	Being added to scam groups
Approve new members	• • • •	A stolen text code
Groups privacy: my contacts	• • • •	Notices lost in hundreds of replies
Two-step verification	• • • •	Strangers joining by link

4 **Which of these is safe to post in a 300-member parents' group?**

- ◯ A photo of pupils at the school gate
- ◯ A pupil's report card
- ◯ Sports day moved to Thursday
- ◯ A class list with phone numbers

5 **Which privacy setting stops strangers adding you to groups?**

- ◯ Groups: Everyone
- ◯ Groups: My contacts
- ◯ Read receipts: Off
- ◯ Last seen: Nobody

Answers · for the teacher

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1 **Only admins can send messages; Only admins can edit group info; Admins approve new members**

When only admins send, notices stay clear instead of getting lost in replies; when only admins edit the group info, nobody can change its name or picture to trick members; and approving new members stops strangers with the link from walking in.

2 **False**

Members can usually see each other's numbers, and anyone can save or forward a post.

3 **Only admins send messages — Notices lost in hundreds of replies**
Approve new members — Strangers joining by link
Groups privacy: my contacts — Being added to scam groups
Two-step verification — A stolen text code

Each setting closes a different door. Together, they protect the group and your own account.

4 **Sports day moved to Thursday**

A general notice has no personal details.

5 **Groups: My contacts**

With Groups set to My contacts, only people in your contacts can add you; anyone else has to send you an invite, which you can ignore.

For you to think about

Think of one school group you're in. Which setting or rule would you change first, and who would you ask to help?